Working on the social and economic pillars (sustainable development policies, programmes and targeted schemes) have been introduced to eradicate poverty either through a direct focus on economic indicators like employment generation, youth mobilisation, and building up assets of the poor; or indirectly through social indicators of human development with emphasis on health, education, and women's empowerment. As per the **Census-2011**, many parameters on this front have shown improvement, however, India is still not on target to meet some key MDGs by 2015.

- The *poverty* head-count ratio declined by 7.3 percentage points from 2004-5 to 2009-10;
- The *MMR* (maternal mortality rate) dropped from 301 per 100,000 live births in 2001-3 to 212 in 2007-9; and
- *literacy* rates have been constantly rising and are estimated to be 82.14 per cent for men and 65.46 per cent for women.

Over the years, arguments in favour of looking beyond the conventional measure of GDP and taking into account the environmental damage caused by production of goods and services received attention. An expert group under the chairmanship of Prof Sir Partha Dasgupta has been set up to develop a framework for 'Green National Accounts' for India. In fact, the Central Statistics Office (CSO) under the Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (**MOSPI**) has been publishing comprehensive environment statistics since 1997. The process of putting in place a system for natural resources accounting was initiated by MOSPI way back in 2002.

Sustainable Development and Lower Carbon Strategies of the 12th Plan

The Twelfth Plan strategy[4] suggests that there are significant ***'co-benefits'*** for climate action with inclusive and sustainable growth. India as a large responsible player with very low income has also to ensure that these efforts are matched by equitable and fair burden sharing among countries, taking into account the historical responsibilities for emissions. These issues are being discussed in the UNFCCC.